

CRIATIVO GLOBAL NEWSLETTER



Teaching in the Age of AI: What Should Never Change

Artificial intelligence is moving rapidly from an emerging technology to an everyday part of education. Across India and the wider region, schools are introducing AI literacy, training teachers and reconsidering how technology should fit into teaching and learning.

This month, we look at how education systems are responding to AI, and at the question beneath the technology: **what should remain unmistakably human in learning?**

India: AI Education Moves Into the Classroom

India is moving from discussing AI in education to **integrating it into the curriculum**. From 2026/2027, NCERT and CBSE are introducing AI and computational thinking from Classes III to VIII. The aim is to help students **understand, question and use AI responsibly, not simply operate AI tools**.



A Perspective from Criativo

As AI reshapes how students learn and create, teachers are becoming even more important. In the recent **Criativo's Chairman, Krishna Nallamilli's reflection highlights teachers as influencers of curiosity, confidence and critical thinking**, using AI as a tool while continuing to provide the human connection, judgement and understanding that technology cannot replace.



TEACHING BEYOND THE TOOL



India: Schools are Asking for Rules, Not Just Technology

A national survey of Indian schools found that AI adoption remains at an early stage, with only **13% reporting advanced integration**. Meanwhile, **91% of teachers called for clear guidelines** on student AI use, citing concerns around privacy, overdependence and academic integrity.

The findings highlight the need for schools to move beyond simply restricting AI and instead **teach students how to question, verify and use it responsibly**.

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UAE: AI Enters the Curriculum with Ethics Built In

The UAE is making AI education a formal part of schooling, introducing a curriculum covering **AI, data, algorithms, risks and ethics**, while planning to **train 22,000 teachers and educators** in AI-enabled teaching and assessment.

The shift highlights that AI literacy is about more than technical skills, it also **requires ethical judgement, awareness of risks and strong human guidance**.

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Saudi Arabia: AI Becomes Part of the New School Year

Saudi Arabia has added **50 AI-focused educational units** for the 2026/2027 academic year, alongside expanded teacher training and AI tools to support educators.

The move reflects a wider Gulf shift toward integrating AI across education, not just as a subject, but as a capability that **strengthens teaching while keeping human expertise at the centre**.

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FROM AI LITERACY TO HUMAN LITERACY



India: Teachers Take a More Central Role in AI Literacy

AI literacy is not just about student, it also depends on teacher readiness. **The August AI Samarth convening at IIT Madras** highlighted practical uses of AI in teaching, while emphasizing the need for teacher confidence and contextual understanding. **Teachers remain essential to ensuring AI supports learning rather than replaces human judgement.**

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What the Research Says: AI Works Best When it Augments Thinking - Not Replaces it

Emerging research suggests AI is most effective when it **supports rather than replaces learning**. Studies highlight the importance of AI literacy, self-regulation and critical thinking, while raising concerns about overdependence and its impact on creativity.

The takeaway is clear: **AI should enhance learning, not do the thinking for students**. Students still need opportunities to question, create, collaborate and make independent judgements.

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Closing Note

The key question for education is no longer just **what AI can do, but what we want students to become**. As AI becomes more integrated into education, schools must ensure that technology develops alongside **curiosity, empathy, creativity, collaboration and independent thinking**.

The goal is not less AI, but more deliberate human thinking.